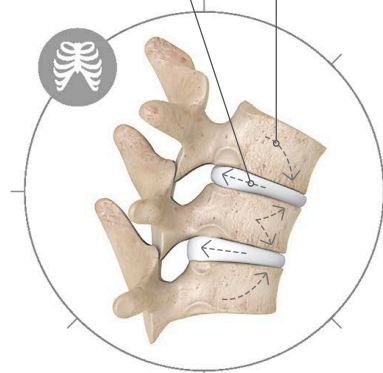


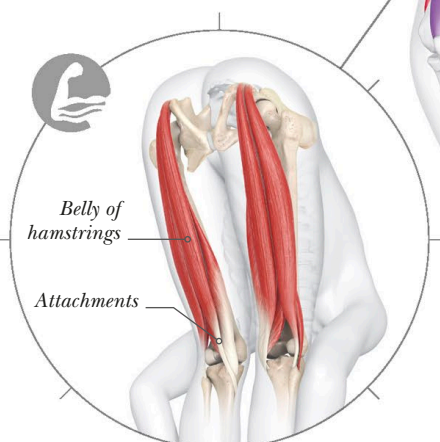
Disks naturally shift backward

Vertebral bodies move and tilt forward



Spinal disks

When your spine flexes, your resilient intervertebral disks naturally push posteriorly. Spinal nerves thread between your vertebrae and are vulnerable to compression, such as from disk herniation. You would likely know if your nerves were being pinched because of numbness, tingling, or shooting pain.



Feeling the pull

Feel the pull in the belly of the muscle, not the attachments. Muscle tissue has more elasticity to stretch, and blood flow to heal, than the connective tissue of joint structures. If you feel a sharp pull near the attachments, bend your knees, or don't go as deeply into the pose.

Gluteus maximus stretches strongly

Adductor magnus stretches, but may engage a little as well

Hamstrings stretch

Triceps brachii may engage to synergize with your biceps brachii

Gastrocnemius particularly stretches with the knees extended

POSTERIOR VIEW